

WORKING DRAFT

ClassE US language guide

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PURPOSE

To guide us in making language choices that accurately reflect our product and our beliefs.

GOAL

US buyers hear a partner who shares their beliefs about students and teachers, and they trust ClassE with their students.

STATUS

This is the current working draft as of September 29, 2026. We plan to keep updating it. Anything in it should be reviewed before we use it.

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Why this matters

The main purpose of this guide is not to give exact language, but to guide us in making language choices that accurately reflect our product and our beliefs, and that position us with US educators as aligned on what we all want: supporting students, helping teachers, improving outcomes and helping every student reach their full potential.

Where we propose specific language, there are often other options, and we may ultimately choose a different one.

US buyers are skeptical of edtech. Many have been burned before, so they look for signals, good or bad. They answer to their community for every choice they make with public money. A district that buys ClassE is saying, “This is the best place to spend public funds for our kids.” So we have to be above reproach.

What matters most is not the words. It is the mindsets behind them, and these beliefs are ours. This guide helps us say them the way US educators say them.

Most of the lines under “Sounds like” come from our own calls, including some of Christopher’s. They work in Israel. A US buyer hears them differently, so we keep the idea and change the words.

- Before a call, read everything up to the word list.
- Before a deck or email goes out, check the word list.

Our language has to match what ClassE actually does. ClassE measures student progress, analyzes the data, and then does two things.

WHAT OUR WORDS HAVE TO DESCRIBE

1 It helps the teacher. The teacher gets whole-class, small-group and student-specific recommendations, such as targeted support. The dashboard shows each student’s current progress toward mastery of each objective or standard, precise to the question. This takes seconds or minutes, not hours of grading and spreadsheets. The teacher decides what to do.

2 It helps every student directly. When a student misses a question, ClassE gives a second question on the same skill, written a different way (the twin question). Albert, our AI tutor, asks the student questions so the student works it out. Every student gets extra reps on what they missed.

3 So intervention is a two-part answer. With Albert on, ClassE delivers some of the targeted support itself. With Albert off, it helps the teacher intervene: it shows where each student is, groups students, and gives the teacher recommendations. Where a district limits student-facing AI, the second question still works without Albert.

The short version

OUR CORE BELIEFS

1 Every child can, and will, grow.

Every child can make radical growth in the right conditions. Our job is to help build those conditions.

2 Kids do well if they can.

This is an idea from Ross Greene, a US psychologist. A student who is struggling is missing a skill, not the will. When a student has a learning gap, it means we have not found the right way yet. Never, ever because the kid does not want to.

3 We never blame students or families.

Nothing we say can be heard as blaming kids or not believing in them. We never blame parents. Families are our partners.

4 Every student is an individual.

We see each student as an individual. We never generalize about a child from a group or from one story. A student's culture, language and community are strengths the student brings.

Every part of this guide reflects one or more of these beliefs.

THREE THINGS TO REMEMBER

1

“We help the student up to the question. We don’t bring the question down to the student.”

“Help” says the student gets support to reach the question. School teams will always be able to modify and accommodate a student’s work.

2

“The teacher leads. ClassE supports.”

3

“We don’t have a controlled study on that yet. Here’s what we can show you.”

WORDS WE USE

These work well with US educators. Several came out of our September workshop.

1

For what ClassE does: which students missed which standard, down to the question, recommended groups and next steps, extra reps, formative assessment data, progress toward mastery, targeted practice, personalized practice and feedback, the second question, data-informed, curriculum-aligned (where ClassE is set up for that curriculum), accessibility supports

2

For what the teacher does: targeted instruction, small-group follow-up, reteach and reinforce, next steps

3

For students: a student with a disability, English learner or multilingual learner, students who have not shown this skill yet

4

For results: a correct response, score band, performance level

Seven kinds of words that land wrong

KIND	✓ TRY INSTEAD	✗ SOUNDS LIKE
Labels a child. It ranks kids, or turns them into a group.	"Seven students missed this skill. The teacher can teach them in a small group."	"Closing the gaps with the weakest students."
Out of date. It sounds careless in a US school today.	"Your English learners." In Texas, "your emergent bilingual students."	"Your ESL students."
Undercuts teachers. It says the teacher is the problem.	"The teacher leads. ClassE supports."	"The platform is teacher-proof."
The district's word. It sounds like a vendor overstepping a legal or formal process.	"The student got these questions wrong on this skill. This is where we focus next."	"We can do 10 exercises and diagnose exactly what the problem is."
Politically charged. It takes a side the buyer did not ask about.	What ClassE does for each student. Follow the buyer's lead.	"An equity engine that dismantles traditional testing and builds belonging."
Unmeasured claim or sales talk. A skeptical buyer will ask how we know. Usage is not a result.	"Schools in Israel use it. We don't have a controlled study of its effect on grades yet."	"Thousands of kids that use ClassE in Israel have better grades."
Sounds translated. It is understood, but it marks the speaker as not from here.	"Practice."	"An exercise platform."

ALWAYS Use the buyer's word first. Never correct how a buyer talks about its own students, and never repeat what one district says about itself to another.

Before the call

- ☐ Check the state, and whether you are meeting a district, a charter network or one school. Then read "Texas and New York, side by side."
- ☐ If a report on screen says "mastery," say what it shows: "These students got this question right."
- ☐ Before any conversation with a district, check its student-facing AI policies and local laws. That decides how much Albert becomes a selling point. Do not mention text to speech until the team confirms it works in the US product.
- ☐ If teachers are in the meeting, talk to them, not about them: "You see which students missed which skill. You decide what to do next."

If a word goes wrong in the call

"What do you call this in your schools?"

"I may be missing local context. How does this work in your schools?"

"Let me say that more carefully."

"I don't know. I'll find out and get back to you."

IF A BUYER ASKS

- 1** "So you're like i-Ready?" "Some parts are similar. Let's show you what happens after a student misses a question."
- 2** **About progress monitoring:** It is the district's process, tied to IEP goals and tiered support. Say what ClassE shows: "which questions each student got right and wrong, on which skill, this week."
- 3** **About English learners, IEPs and advanced students:** These are three separate questions. Ask: "What supports does your district already use for each?"
- 4** **About the AI:** Do not say the AI explains or teaches. Say what the student sees: "The student gets a second question on the same skill."
- 5** **About a product they already pay for:** Do not offer to replace it. Ask: "What do your teachers use it for today?"

Texas and New York, side by side

The same word can be safe in one state and risky in the other. The laws and policies in this section were checked in September 2026.

	Texas	New York and the Northeast
Law and policy	SB 12, a Texas law limiting DEI work in K-12 schools, in effect since September 1, 2025. A federal court has blocked parts of it in some districts while the case continues.	The Culturally Responsive-Sustaining Education Framework, New York State guidance since 2019.
Equity words	Do not raise equity, DEI or identity words. If the district uses one, follow its lead.	Many schools use equity, identity and asset framing words. Follow the buyer’s lead. Using a buyer’s own words is not the same as raising DEI.
How to open	“ClassE gives students practice on your curriculum and your standards, once we set it up with you.” Say “TEKS” only after the team confirms the alignment.	The same sentence.
State test	STAAR. A 2025 law, HB 8, replaces it with new tests starting in 2027-28. Use the name the district uses. Its top level is “Masters Grade Level,” so Texas educators say “masters” as an official label. Never use “mastery” for a ClassE result.	The New York State tests.
English learners	“Emergent bilingual” for the student. “ESL” or “bilingual” for the program.	“English Language Learners (ELLs),” the New York State term. New York also uses “Multilingual Learners (MLs)” for a wider group. “ENL” for the program.

Word list, A to Z

Look up a word before you use it. Each suggestion is one option, not the only one.

✗ WORD OR PHRASE	✓ TRY INSTEAD	WHY
“Acceleration,” for ClassE	“Targeted practice.” Use “acceleration” only for the district’s own program.	In Texas it is a program set in law, with minimum hours and tutor ratios.
“Accommodate” and “modify,” mixed up	“Accommodation” when the student reaches the same work another way. “Modification” when the work itself changes.	In US special education they are different decisions, and the student’s IEP or 504 team makes them. Mixing them up signals we don’t know the system.
“ADHD students,” “cognitive issues,” “students with different diagnosed learning disabilities”	“A student with a disability,” or what the student needs.	A student’s disability category is private.
AI hype: “a revolution in education,” “30 personalized tutors that know your students”	Describe what the AI does. “Albert, the AI tutor, asks the student questions, so the student works it out.”	No one can check it.
“Any curriculum”	“We set it up with your curriculum.”	Check with the product team before promising it to a specific district.
“At risk,” “low performing,” about a student	“Students who have not shown this skill yet.”	In Texas, at risk is a legal category. Low performing is a federal term for schools.
“Bring the students to the test,” “the exact model of what they’re going to see on that test”	“We help the student up to the question.” “We build the practice on your curriculum and your standards.”	It sounds like teaching to the test.
“Competency issues,” “needs help,” “competent,” about a student	“This student missed these three questions.”	It labels the child. Describe the answers.
“Data-driven”	“Data-informed.”	It sounds like the numbers make the decisions.
“Depends a lot on the quality of the teachers”	Do not raise it.	It judges the buyer’s staff.
“Diagnostic,” “assessment platform,” “diagnostic and remediation tool,” as the first thing we say about ClassE	Lead with what ClassE does. “Diagnostic” is fine later, about skills and standards.	The first label decides what the buyer compares ClassE to. Buyers who heard “diagnostic” first said, “Oh, so you’re i-Ready.”

✗ WORD OR PHRASE	✓ TRY INSTEAD	WHY
“Diagnose” about a child: “diagnose exactly what the problem is”	“ClassE shows which students missed which standard, down to the question.”	“Diagnose” sounds like a doctor. In a US school, only an evaluation, with the parent’s consent, decides whether a student has a disability. Keep the speed and precision, and say it about the learning.
“Drill and kill,” or any other product, run down	Describe what ClassE does.	The district may use that product.
Equity, DEI, “culturally responsive”	Follow the buyer’s lead. Never use them for ClassE.	In Texas, state law limits DEI work. In either state, never describe ClassE as doing equity work itself.
“ESL students,” “LEP”	“English learner” or “multilingual learner.” In Texas, “emergent bilingual.”	ESL is a program, not a name for a child. Federal law replaced LEP.
“Exactly where the student’s reasoning is breaking down”	“Here are the questions the student got wrong on this skill.”	It claims to see inside the student’s head.
“An exercise platform,” “marks”	“Practice,” “practice questions,” “scores.”	“An exercise platform” can sound like a fitness app to a US ear. “Marks” is British usage.
Guessing about families: “these parents are working two jobs, they just don’t have time”	“What does support at home look like in your community?”	It guesses about families as a group.
“I don’t see color”	Do not raise race.	Today it can sound like not seeing the student.
“Intervention,” “intervention platform,” as the name for ClassE	Give the two-part answer: “The teacher gets what they need to intervene in minutes, not hours. And Albert gives every student targeted support right away.”	On its own, “intervention” tells a US buyer we are a formal Tier 2 or Tier 3 program, and they will ask for that evidence. Say what each part does.
“Mastered,” “proficient,” “masters of this skill,” for a ClassE result	“A correct response.” Over time: “They got most questions on this standard right, over several weeks.”	These are state test labels. One question cannot carry them. “Progress toward mastery” over several weeks is fine.
“Meets FERPA,” “meets WCAG,” or any standard	“I’ll find out and get back to you.”	Not until the product team confirms it. Buyers worry about student data inside an AI system.
“Neurodivergent student,” as the general term	What the student needs.	It is a word some people use about themselves. Follow the family’s lead.
One student’s story as proof	“That’s one student’s result. It’s not proof yet.”	One story is not evidence, and it generalizes from one child.
“Progress monitoring,” for ClassE	Describe the evidence in plain words.	It is the district’s process, tied to IEP goals and tiered support.
“Proven,” “evidence-based,” “ESSA certified”	“We don’t have a controlled study on that yet. Here’s what we can show you.” “Evidence-informed design.”	ESSA tiers rate the evidence behind a program. The federal government does not certify products.
“Remediation,” for ClassE	“Targeted practice.” Use “remediation” if the district says it first.	It is the district’s word to choose.
“The same difficulty,” for the second question	“A second question on the same skill.”	No field-test data or item statistics show it yet.

✗ WORD OR PHRASE	✓ TRY INSTEAD	WHY
“Saves a lot of time for teachers”	“No more hours of grading and spreadsheets. The data is there in minutes.”	Name the work that goes away. A principal who hears “saves time” can hear that the teacher will have less to do.
“Special needs kids,” “SPED student,” “special accommodations”	“A student with a disability.” For ClassE features: “accessibility supports,” once confirmed for the US.	Name the student first. Accessibility is not special education.
“Teacher-proof,” “make them better teachers,” “faster than teachers”	“The teacher leads. ClassE supports.” “ClassE shows the teacher sooner which students missed which skill.”	In a US school it says the vendor thinks the teacher is the problem.
“These kids”	“Let’s look at what each student did.”	It turns individual students into a group.
Tiers: “a Tier 1 type of remediation,” “your Tier 3 kids,” “tier to tier” for scores	Tiers only for what the district runs. For scores: “score band,” “performance level.”	Tiers are the district’s system, never a name for ClassE or a student.
“Upload an IEP”	Do not offer it.	An IEP is a confidential student record.
Usage as a result: how many students or schools use it	“Here is what students got right and wrong, on which skills.”	Usage is not a result.
“Weak students,” “strong students,” “a GAP student,” “a pretty good student”	“Each student gets practice on the skill they missed.”	It ranks children. Praise is still a judgment.

05

Appendix

For the product team

Some of these words are on the screen, and a rep can’t talk around them in a demo.

- The report says “mastery” off one question. Decide what it calls a correct answer, and what it calls a skill shown over time.
- If the product labels students with words like “needs help” or “competent,” describe what the student did instead.

US terms

504 plan A plan under Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act for a student with a disability who needs accommodations.

IDEA Individuals with Disabilities Education Act, the special education law.

ENL English as a New Language, the New York program name.

IEP Individualized Education Program.

ESSA Every Student Succeeds Act, which sets the evidence tiers.

MTSS Multi-Tiered System of Supports.

FERPA Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act, on student records.

STAAR The Texas state test.

Sources

Sources, with laws and legal terms checked in September 2026:

- at risk, Texas Education Code 29.081.
- Emergent bilingual, Texas Education Code 29.052.
- Acceleration, Texas HB 4545 and HB 1416.
- LEP, replaced by “English learner” in ESSA (2015).
- SB 12, in effect September 1, 2025, with parts blocked by a federal court in some districts while the case continues.
- STAAR, replaced by new tests starting in 2027-28 under Texas HB 8 (2025).
- New York student data, Education Law 2-d requires a data privacy agreement when a vendor receives student data.
- Neurodivergent, not one of the 13 IDEA disability categories.
- Kids do well if they can, Ross Greene.